Ahmed Skali

Department of Global Economics and Management
University of Groningen

Email: ahmedskali@gmail.com
Homepage: ahmedskali.com
Citizenship: Australia, Morocco

Research Interests

Political economy, behavioural economics, development economics, culture and institutions

Current Roles

Senior Assistant Professor (*universitair docent 1*), with tenure, Department of Global Economics & Management, University of Groningen, 2021-

Associate Editor & Methods Advisor, *The Leadership Quarterly*, 2024 -

Selected Publications

For a complete list, see my Google Scholar (h-index 16; 1,739 citations).

Wealth Inequality and Economic Growth: Evidence from the World Inequality Database, with R Steenbrink
World Development, 199 (2026).

Violent Conflict and Parochial Trust: Lab-in-the-Field and Survey Evidence, with K Werner
Journal of Development Economics, 177 (2025).

Not All About the Money: Service Quality Information Improves Consumer Decision-Making, with J Blijlevens, SH Chuah, A Neelim, and J Prasch
Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, 228 (2024).

National Identity Predicts Public Health Support During a Global Pandemic, with J Van Bavel et al
Nature Communications, 13 (2022).

Trust in Government in Times of Crisis: A Quasi-Experiment During the Two World Wars, with D Stadelmann and B Torgler
Journal of Comparative Economics, 49 (2021).

Child Labour and Psychosocial Well-Being: Findings from India, with S Feeny, A Jyotishi, S Nath, A Posso, and PK Viswanathan
Health Economics, 30 (2021).

How Often Do Dictators Have Positive Economic Effects? Global Evidence, 1858-2010, with S Rizio
The Leadership Quarterly, 31 (2020).

2020 Winner, *The Leadership Quarterly* Best Paper Award
Selected media: *The Independent*, *Quartz*, *ABC Radio*, *Marginal Revolution*, *Neue Zürcher Zeitung*

Moralizing Gods and Armed Conflict.
Journal of Economic Psychology, 63 (2017).

Does Democracy Drive Income in the World, 1500-2000?, with JB Madsen and PA Raschky
European Economic Review, 78 (2015).

Working Papers

Protestantism and Effort Expenditure on the Battlefield: Soldier-Level Evidence from World War II, with T Beatton and B Torgler

Required reading for EC1450 Religion and Political Economy (R Barro and R McCleary, Harvard University).

Transportation Infrastructure and Child Mortality: Sub-National Evidence for 22 Developing Countries, with R Boot

Revised and Resubmitted to *Health Economics*

The Cost of Nativism: Evidence from the Netherlands, with H Garretsen

Revisions requested, *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*

Invited Keynote Address

Against Practical Science, Australian Research Council BITA (Behavioural Insights for Technology Adoption) Conference, Brisbane, Australia, 2026

Education

Ph.D., Department of Economics, Monash University, October 2015

Thesis title: *Essays in Political Economy*

M.A., Economics, University of Delaware, 2008

M.A., Monnaie, Finance et Gouvernance, Université Lumière Lyon 2, 2008

B.S., Economics, University of Delaware, 2006

Licence en Sciences Economiques et de Gestion, Université Lumière Lyon 2, 2005

Teaching and Advising

Thesis Advising

PhD Students (expected completion): Sam Oxley (2026), Sophie von Russdorf (2028), Patricia Galliford (2028)

Master's Theses: 10 completed (MSc International Economics & Sustainable Development, 2021 – present)

Bachelor's Theses: 10 completed (BSc International Business, 2021 – present)

Advised master's papers outcomes: publication in *World Development*; R&R at *Health Economics*.

Teaching Recognition

Top 5 best teacher, Faculty of Economics and Business, University of Groningen: Spring 2021

Top 5 best course, Faculty of Economics and Business, University of Groningen: Fall 2024

Graduate

Globalization Debates, Econometric Techniques

Undergraduate

Growth and Development Economics, Sustainability and Globalization, International Economics, Behavioural Business, Microeconomics (various courses)

Guest Lectures

Erasmus University Rotterdam (2022): The Economics of Climate Change: An Overview

Royal Melbourne Institute of Technology (2018, 2019): The Perils of Leadership without Constraints

Competitive Funding

Total competitive funding awarded: USD 283,234

Sole investigator, *The Devil You Don't Know*, Dutch Scientific Council (NWO) research grant, 2026, €49,830.

Sole investigator, Alfred Deakin Fellowship, Deakin University, 2020, A$200,000

Co-Investigator, *Service Quality and Consumer Choice in Energy Retail Markets*. Consumer Policy Research Centre, 2018, A$73,853

Co-Investigator: Seed Funding, International Development and Trade Research Group. RMIT, 2017, A$38,000

Sole investigator, Early Career Researcher Publication Award. RMIT, 2018, A$4,980

Sole investigator, PAFTAD Travel Fellowship, 2018, A$3,000

Professional Activity

Invited talks (selected):

Harvard University, MIT Sloan, University of California – Irvine, University of Tokyo, University of Melbourne (Economics Department), University of Melbourne (School of Psychological Sciences), Monash University, Hamburg Lectures in Law and Economics, Cultures of Trust and Institutions of Freedom Workshop (IFN Stockholm).

Professional roles:

Steering committee member, Centre for Public Health in Economics and Business, University of Groningen, 2022 -

Chair, Economics of Religion Research Cluster, RMIT, 2017 - 2018

Deputy Chair, Behavioural Business Lab, RMIT, 2018 - 2020

Advisor, Business College Human Ethics Advisory Network, RMIT, 2018 - 2020

Economics Seminar Coordinator, Swinburne University of Technology, 2016

Academic visits:

Centre for Behavioural Economics, Society and Technology, Queensland University of Technology, December 2019

Chair of Development Economics, University of Bayreuth, January 2018

School of Economics and Finance, Queensland University of Technology, October - December 2016

Conference organization:

2020 Natural Experiments in History Workshop, 2018 Australasian Public Choice Conference

Refereeing (selected):

European Economic Review, Dutch Scientific Council (NWO), The Leadership Quarterly, Health Economics, Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization, Journal of Economics & Management Strategy, Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics, Journal of Population Economics, Economic Inquiry, Kyklos, Regional Studies, Technovation, Review of World Economics *(Weltwirtschaftliches Archiv)*

Conference discussant:

2023 European Public Choice Society, 2018 Pacific Trade and Development Conference, 2016 Public Choice Society Meetings

Thesis examinations:

PhD: Monash University (2018), University of Newcastle (2022), Deakin University (2024)

Honours: Queensland University of Technology (2017, 2018)

Academic Memberships

Research Fellow (External), Centre for Behavioural Economics, Society and Technology, Queensland University of Technology, 2016 -

Fellow, Global Labor Organization, 2023 -

Affiliate, Households in Conflict Network (HiCN), 2023 -

Research Affiliate, *Groningen Growth and Development Centre*, 2021-

Research Affiliate, *In the LEAD* Centre of Expertise, 2021-

Previous Roles

Lecturer, Department of Economics, Royal Melbourne Institute of Technology, 2017 - 2020

Research Fellow, Faculty of Business and Law, Swinburne University of Technology, 2015 - 2016

References

Professor Jakob B. Madsen
Department of Economics
The University of Western Australia
Perth, Australia
jakob.madsen@uwa.edu.au

Professor Paul A. Raschky
Department of Economics
Monash University
Melbourne, Australia
paul.raschky@monash.edu

Professor Benno Torgler
School of Economics & Finance
Queensland University of Technology
Brisbane, Australia
benno.torgler@qut.edu.au